

Riding the Leopard

I have left the wealthy lands of the Lydians and Phrygians, the sun-parched plains of the Persians, and the Bactrian walls, and have passed over the wintry land of the Medes, and blessed Arabia, and all of Asia which lies along the coast of the salt sea

...And I have come to this Hellene city first, having already set those other lands to dance and established my mysteries there, so that I might be a deity manifest among men.

In this land of Hellas, I have first excited Thebes to my cry, fitting a fawn-skin to my body and taking a thyrsos in my hand, a weapon of ivy. For my mother's sisters, the ones who least should, claimed that I, Dionysus, was not the child of Zeus,

But that Semele had conceived a child from a mortal father and then ascribed the sin of her bed to Zeus, a trick for which they boasted that Zeus killed her, because she had told a false tale about her marriage. Therefore I have goaded them from the house in frenzy, and they dwell in the mountains, out of their wits;

I have compelled them to wear the outfit of my mysteries. All the female off spring of Thebes I have driven maddened from the house, and they sit on roofless rocks beneath green pines. For this city must learn, even if it is unwilling, that it is not initiated into my Bacchic rites, and that I plead the case of my mother, Semele, in appearing manifest to mortals as a divinity whom she bore to Zeus.

Now Kadmos has given his honor and Power to Pentheus, who fights against the gods as far as I am concerned and drives me away from sacrifices, and in his prayers makes no mention of me, for which I will show him and all the Thebans that I was born a god.

Walk into
madness
Dancing
Frenzied

Even if you try to tie me up
I will always track you down

Wild hearts
Red earth
Nature's
Foul face

Trying to deny I'm a part of you
Trying to refuse benevolence

Blood rites
Raw flesh
Warm tears
Delight

Come dine, with my wine
Unwind and let go

All in vain sprouting
It's all in vain sprouting
All in vain sprouting the seeds of life

Flowers blight if refused
Flowers blight if refused
Flowers blight if refused
By the hands of ignorance

All the leaves mildew
And all the vines entangle
Red grapes sour as they
Fall onto the ground

May this firm ground tremble
May this firm ground tremble
May this firm ground tremble
May the world turn upside down

A leopard cub hiding
Like a leopard cub hiding
A leopard cub hiding
Amongst white sheep

Look at your paws and realize
Look at your fangs and realize
Look at your claws and realize
Nature shines through you

As you bleat loudly
And as you chew on dry grass
You forget you're destined
To eat raw flesh

May your loud roar rumble
May your loud roar rumble
May your loud roar rumble
May the world turn upside down